

Carlo Alberto Degli Atti

Innovation, AI & Product Leader · Product Lead at PagoPA

The best technology is the kind you don't see.

Milan, Italy
lordkada.it
linkedin.com/in/lordkada
github.com/lordkada
lordkada.medium.com

PROFILE

I take AI and new ideas from prototype to production, including inside large, regulated organisations. Today I'm Product Lead at PagoPA, the state-controlled company behind Italy's public digital payments and services platforms, where we launched the Public Administration's first developer portal and an AI assistant that grew into an open-source RAG platform. Before that I co-founded six companies across Italy and the United States, with two exits. Every chapter started with a leap — from student to entrepreneur, from consulting to software products, from Milan to San Francisco, from entrepreneur to intrapreneur. And I still build hands-on: AI agents, local-first computer vision, and research on artificial valence.

HOW I WORK

Zero to one
At my best when a product doesn't exist yet; my ground is 0→1 more than scale-up.

Remove friction, don't add interfaces
The best technology is the kind you don't see.

Build to understand
Close to the code, ideas tested against real-world constraints.

Trust first, then autonomy
Especially with AI: privacy by design, autonomy only where it is reliable.

Quick, not dirty
Every step becomes solid ground for the next; prototype before building the real product.

Small teams, clear ownership
Two-pizza teams, cross-pollination, proactive people; no diffused responsibility.

EXPERIENCE

Product Lead · PagoPA S.p.A., Milan — 2021 - now

- Senior Product Manager (2021-2023), then Product Lead (since 2023). Joined the Strategic Innovation department, working on EU-funded innovation projects and laying the groundwork for the Developer Portal.
- Today I lead three main initiatives, each with a dedicated team of 4–6 people, plus a few early-stage ones: 15–20 people in all, in cross-functional teams spanning tech, design, legal and account management.
- Launched the Developer Portal, the first developer portal of the Italian Public Administration: a single place to integrate PagoPA's products, used by thousands of public bodies and technology partners (covered by Wired Italia, December 2023).
- Released DOS68K, an open-source RAG platform spun off from the Developer Portal's AI assistant.

Senior Product Manager · HELLO Mobility, Milan — 2020 - 2021

- Took the HELLO app to production: parking, EV charging and micromobility in a single platform.

Co-Founder · International STEM Awards, Milan — 2019 - 2020

- An international platform where young people aged 7 to 25 put forward STEM projects on global challenges, judged by a scientific committee from Italian and European universities and research centres.
- The first edition, moved entirely online by the pandemic, gathered 118 projects from about 300 young people in 10 countries.

How it ended: wound down because of the pandemic, still in profit.

CEO & Co-Founder · Thingle.me, San Francisco — 2015 - 2019

- Customer support software built for physical products: a QR code or NFC tag on the object takes its owner straight to the manufacturer's support, no app download needed.

- In 2018 launched Thingly, a conversational AI assistant to manage appliances, warranties and maintenance.

How it ended: after raising funding, we couldn't hold our ground in a highly competitive market and the company was wound down.

Chief Technology Officer · Styloola, Milan 2014

- Led the development of the Styloola Box, a Wi-Fi device that measures footfall and shopper behaviour in stores.

CEO & Co-Founder · Opinionage Inc., San Francisco 2011 - 2015

- Launched opinionage.com, the social network of opinions (2011), then brought its technology to SMEs with HUBNGO, a platform to build online communities (2013).
- Featured in *Starting-Up in America* (2011), a documentary on international founders building companies in Silicon Valley.

How it ended: here too we raised funding, but competition in the space was fierce; the company was wound down.

Co-Founder & CTO · Couponline, Milan 2004 - 2009

- With ScontoQui, delivered personalised coupons at the store entrance, requested with an optical code or a mobile phone call, before smartphones came along.

How it ended: outcompeted by much larger players, we ran out of cash before we could enforce our patents. The company was wound down.

CEO & Co-Founder · Concept srl, Milan 2000 - 2011

- A team of up to 12–15 people.
- Turned consulting into software products: myK, an Enterprise Feedback Management platform listed by Gartner in 2010 among the leading solutions in the field.

How it ended: I sold my shares to my partners, my second exit.

CEO & Co-Founder · Information Delivery Systems S.r.l., Milan 1997 - 2000

- A Business Intelligence consulting boutique, founded while still at university, that grew to 25–30 people.

How it ended: acquired by a larger company, my first exit.

EDUCATION

MSc, Information Sciences (Scienze dell'Informazione) — Università degli Studi di Milano

Product Management — Stanford Online, 2025-2026: *Transforming Opportunities into Great Products · Mastering Product Management: Building Your Strategy · User Research: Informing Product Decisions with Customer Insights · Demand Creation: Launching and Growing Your Product*

Deep Learning Specialization — Coursera / deeplearning.ai, 2018: *Neural Networks and Deep Learning · Improving Deep Neural Networks · Structuring Machine Learning Projects · Convolutional Neural Networks · Sequence Models*

Contributor to the Italian edition of *Soluzioni open source per la PMI* (John Locke) — Tecniche Nuove, 2005

SIDE PROJECTS

Artificial valence — an architecture in which the consequences of its actions matter to the machine, tested on a real robot

Personal AI agent — follows my email and messaging, keeps their context and proposes actions, taken only on my approval

Lurch Home — open-source, privacy-first smart butler for agentic AI

Local-first vision — CLIP and ArcFace tools for on-device photo archives

LANGUAGES

Italian — native

English — fluent (C1)

French — conversational